

Lecture no. 12:-

Spam Detection Maths - Bayes Rule

Real World

Applying Bayes Rule to Spam Detection:-

- "You have inherited a million dollars."
- "There will be a meeting at noon."
- Assumption: We have a dataset of spam emails.
- Need to find whether a piece of text is spam.

Let's first consider a single word.

"how frequently does this word appear in spam?"

"how much spam is there in the world?"

$$P(\text{spam} | w) = \frac{P(w | \text{spam}) P(\text{spam})}{P(w)}$$

"Given that this word appears, how likely is it that the message is spam?"

$P(w)$

from dataset "How frequent is this word?"

$$P(\text{spam}) = \frac{\text{No. of spam messages}}{\text{No. of all messages}}$$

$$P(w/\text{spam}) = \frac{\text{no. of times this word appears in spam}}{\text{no. of spam messages}}$$

$$P(w) = \frac{\text{No. of times this word appears}}{\text{No. of total messages}}$$

Now, do this for all words

$$P(\text{spam} | \text{words}) = P(\text{spam} | w_1) * P(\text{spam} | w_2) * \dots * P(\text{spam} | w_n)$$

$$P(\text{spam} | \text{words}) = \prod_{i=1}^{|\text{word}|} P(\text{spam} | w_i)$$

$\therefore \Sigma$ is for summation
So Π is for product
(product of all items in eq)